3. Sree Siddaganga Math website, https://www.siddagangamath.org/siddaganga/home.html. For more details on Basavanna (also known as Basaveshwara, Basava) and the Lingayat/Veerashaiva tradition, see Julia Leslie, 'Understanding Basava: History, hagiography and a modern Kannada drama', *Bulletin of the School of Oriental and African Studies*, University of London, Vol. 61, No. 2, 1998, pp. 228–261.
4. The announcement was made on 19 March 2018, following the recommendations of a seven-member committee headed by former High Court judge Nagamohan Das. The Congress government moved to recognise Lingayats and Veerashaiva-Lingayats who believe in Basava Tattva (philosophy) as a religious minority community under Section (D) of the Karnataka Minorities Act. This opened up a political controversy on three counts.

a. A section of the community saw the reservation move as a political ploy to attract Lingayat voters who are traditionally regarded as pro-BJP;
b. A section of Lingayats complained that they were not distinct from Hinduism;
c. Some Lingayat groups argued that Veerashaivas and Lingayats were the same and alleged that treating them as separate communities (with the government regarding the Veerashaivas as a subsect of the Lingayats) was a cynical ploy aimed at political division.

Manu Aiyappa, 'Karnataka cabinet grants minority status to dominant Lingayats community', *The Times of India*, 18 March 2018, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/bengaluru/karnataka-govt-grants-separate-religion-status-to-lingayat-community/articleshow/63366151.cms; TNN, 'Karnataka govt clears minority status for Lingayats', *The Times of India*, 20 March 2018, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/karnataka-govt-clears-minority-status-for-lingayats/articleshow/63373048.cms.

5. On this, see S.H. Patil, 'Impact of modernisation and democratisation on a dominant community: A case study of the Lingayat community in Karnataka', *The Indian Journal of Political*